



Google TV slow

Google has admitted that its TV software is slow and the company is rolling out some major updates. <https://digit.in/sep22-57>



Apple car secrets stolen

Former Apple employee found guilty of stealing trade secrets about Apple's car division. <https://digit.in/sep22-58>

Realme 9i 5G

Same, same, but different

The Realme 9i 5G is Realme's most affordable 5G phone in India. While it follows the Realme 9i 4G which was launched earlier this year, there are cosmetic and internal changes to make it stand out in the sub-₹15,000 budget segment. With competitors like the Poco M4 Pro 5G and Redmi Note 11T 5G, does it make sense to buy the Realme 9i 5G? Let's find out in this review.

BUILD AND DESIGN

The Realme 9i has an eye-catching design with a shiny and reflective finish that's reminiscent of a CD. Realme hasn't gone with a traditional camera island for the 9i 5G instead the phone has four individual cutouts.

The Realme 9i 5G is also one of the thinnest and most lightweight phones in this segment measuring 8.1mm and weighing in at 187 grams. It's got flat edges on all sides that give it a boxy feel and if you are too bothered about this design you can always slap on a case which will give you better grip and ergonomics for daily use.

DISPLAY

The Realme 9i 5G features a 6.6-inch Full HD+ LCD display which supports a 90Hz refresh rate. The screen also has a dated waterdrop notch for the selfie camera and a slightly wide chin. When it comes to watching videos, the display offers crisp visuals but has a slightly bluish tint that makes visuals look cooler. Sadly, the display doesn't support HDR playback.

During our use, we didn't find the brightness of this display to be in line with Realme's claims. The brand claims the typical brightness to be around 400 nits. In our testing, the Realme 9i 5G could only manage around 314-315 nits of maximum brightness. While the 9i 5G is great for watching content indoors, sunlight legibility is also an issue with such low brightness levels.



around 15 hours before fully discharging. However, Realme supplies a rather slow 18W charging adapter with the 9i 5G.

CAMERA

For its asking price, the Realme 9i 5G takes good pictures in day-to-day use, both from the main and the selfie camera. However, we'll advise buyers not to expect much from the Realme 9i 5G cameras as they are pretty good at producing colourful and detailed images in daylight but lack versatility. It doesn't have an ultra-wide camera and instead, Realme has tried to compensate for it with a macro and depth sensor. However, neither of these sensors brings any kind of holistic improvements to the casual photography experience.

PERFORMANCE

The MediaTek Dimensity 810 chip powering the Realme 9i 5G has stood the test of time and is more than sufficient for things like messaging, calling, watching videos, browsing social media feeds and playing casual games. This chip also brings 5G connectivity to the table.

In our testing, the Realme 9i 5G raked in respectable scores in AnTuTu, Geekbench, PCMark and 3DMark benchmarks, performing equally well if not better than the Snapdragon 695 on the Poco X4 Pro or even the Dimensity 810 on the Redmi Note 11T. We stressed the CPU in the throttling test where the Realme 9i throttled to 87 per cent of its maximum performance. The general gameplay performance in games like COD Mobile and Asphalt 9 remained decent with some minor frame drops here and there.

BATTERY LIFE

If you consider yourself to be a heavy phone user, you'll most likely need to plug the Realme 9i 5G into the charger at the end of a hectic day. But if you're a casual user, the 9i 5G will last you for more than a day easily. In our video loop test, the phone ran for



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VERDICT

The Realme 9i 5G is similar to the Realme 9i 4G but gets 5G and a big performance boost at the cost of features such as stereo speakers, and fast charging. So, if 5G tops the feature list for you, the Realme 9i 5G makes sense in every way. It's affordable, looks unique enough to grab attention, has a powerful processor that you can game on and has a good primary camera. Though if features like fast charging, stereo speakers and a better display make your cut, you should definitely look at phones such as the Poco M4 Pro 5G, Samsung Galaxy F23 and Infinix Note 12.

—Siddharth Chauhan

SPECIFICATIONS

DISPLAY: 6.6-inch LCD, FHD+, 90Hz refresh rate, Panda Glass | THICKNESS: 8.1mm | WEIGHT: 187g | PLATFORM: MediaTek Dimensity 810 | RAM: 4GB/6GB | BUILT-IN STORAGE: 64GB/128GB UFS 2.2 | EXPANDABLE STORAGE: Yes, upto 1TB | USB-C: Yes | 3.5MM JACK: Yes | OS: Realme UI 3.0 based on Android 12 | REAR CAMERA: 50MP (f/1.8) + 2MP macro + 2MP depth sensor | REAR CAMERA VIDEO: 1080p (30FPS) | FRONT CAMERA: 8MP (f/2.0) | SPEAKERS: Single speaker | BATTERY AND CHARGING: 5,000mAh, 18W wired

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